

What is a Daemon? It is a process that does not require interaction with the user to run; for example `init`. Some Daemons run in the background and therefore can also be called background processes. While a Daemon (or any background process) runs, the user can continue using other programs or commands.

What is a Process, Parent process and Child Process? A service that is initiated by `init` is moved into RAM where it becomes a process. Every process has an identification number, or PID (Process Identification). A process resulting from a process (forking) is called the Child Process whereas the Process responsible for its initiation is termed as the Parent Process. The Child Process has a PID and the parent can be identified from its PPID (Parent Process ID).

If you issue the `'ps -el'` command you will see that most processes have PPID as 1; indicating that '`init`' is the mother of all processes. The '`ps tree`' command displays all the process in a tree format listing them under their parent process.

Issue `'ps -aux'` to display all the process with memory usage, cpu usage, PID, etc.

`Vmstat` displays memory information. There are several switches that can be used to get more information out of your system. An example of '`vmstat`' is displayed below:

```
[root@test3 ~]# vmstat
procs -----memory----- --swap-- ----io---- --system-- ----cpu----
r b swpd free buff cache si so bi bo in cs us sy id wa
1 0 0 38516 137448 338300 0 0 30 12 1159 859 7 1 92 1
```

Listed below (see next page) are switches that can be used along with `vmstat`:

If any process is not responding, then open a CLI and check the PID of the non-responsive process using the above command. Terminate the process by issuing the '`kill`' command.

#kill <process id>

Using switch such as '`-9`' will try to terminate the application with immediate effect.